

Tracking their travels

Common cranes breed in Europe and migrate to northern Africa in the winter. There are many different routes, but among the longest are those from Finland to Ethiopia, where the birds cover distances of more than 4,000 miles (6,500 km). Researchers track their route by attaching a radio transmitter to each bird.



**Migrating
common cranes
can cover around
200 miles
(322 km) in
a single day.**

ANIMAL TRACKING

MAPPING MIGRATION

Some animal species make long journeys over huge distances every year. This is called migration, and many animals—including birds, fish, and mammals—do it. Animals may migrate when they are looking for food, mates, a safe place to rear their young, or better weather. Learning the routes that they take helps conservation efforts for endangered animals. Scientists can track the animals through a variety of methods, including by using radio transmitters and a technology called GPS.



TRACKING SALMON

Sockeye salmon begin their lives in freshwater but migrate to the ocean to feed and grow, returning to freshwater to breed. Like all fish, salmon have bonelike structures in their heads, called otoliths. Their composition changes depending on the fish's age and where it has been. By studying otoliths, scientists can track fish migration.